LITTLE WONDERS ESL

Science Word Lab: Simple machines

Level B1 · about 25 minutes · making work easier



1 BRAIN TEASERS

Read the clue. Write the English word in the boxes.

1. I am a bar that turns on a point. A seesaw is an example of me.
2. I use a rope and a wheel to lift a load. A flagpole has one of me.
3. I am a sloping surface. I help you lift heavy things with less force.

2 COOL FACT: LESS FORCE, EASIER WORK

A **simple machine** makes work easier. It can change the size or the direction of a force. A **lever** is a bar that turns on a point. A seesaw is a lever. A **ramp**, or inclined plane, is a sloping surface. It helps us lift heavy things with less force, but we move them over a longer distance. A **wheel** and **axle** makes it easy to move things. A **pulley** uses a rope and a wheel to lift a load. A wedge, such as an axe, splits things. A screw holds things together.

force = a push or a pull

load = a heavy thing that you carry or lift

splits = cuts something into two parts

sloping = higher at one end

3 WORD HUNT

Across or down

P	C	N	E	O	L	N	T	Y	N	E	A
W	E	D	G	E	Q	S	L	E	V	E	R
A	P	T	A	E	R	C	T	I	E	S	S
F	U	C	N	A	I	R	A	M	P	I	A
H	L	D	X	W	H	E	E	L	T	B	X
O	L	R	N	D	R	W	A	K	A	R	L
D	E	E	X	S	C	T	R	O	P	E	E
R	Y	I	Q	N	W	B	D	N	E	A	E

WORD BANK

- ☐ **lever**
- ☐ **pulley**
- ☐ **ramp**
- ☐ **wheel**
- ☐ **rope**
- ☐ **axle**
- ☐ **wedge**
- ☐ **screw**

4 SPEAK

Tell your teacher in your own words (about 1 minute)

1. What does a simple machine do?
2. Can you name two simple machines?
3. How does a ramp help us?